

Business Model

Monetisation options, ranking and launch pricing

Strategic business analysis

Ireland first

5 models ranked

1 Executive decision

Adopt a **layered freemium athlete subscription with a 21-day reverse trial**, then add a coach-sponsored tier once the individual decision loop demonstrates repeat use. A useful free ledger lowers migration and trust friction; recurring evidence-backed decisions, longitudinal memory and multi-source context carry the price.

Commercial stance: do not launch as an all-in-one fitness platform, paid chatbot or data marketplace. Sell one repeated job—“what should I do in today’s planned session, and why?”—with evidence, uncertainty and athlete approval.

The original €99/year hypothesis is directionally credible but premature. Launch Athlete at **€79/year or €8.99/month**, test €99 against it after a paid pilot, and avoid lifetime access because inference, storage, security and connector costs recur.

1.1 Evidence that shapes the model

The attached validation estimates an Irish serviceable audience of 295,500 through a 15% power-user filter and 2,955 early adopters through a 1% adoption assumption. These are planning scenarios, not observed demand. Willingness to pay and retention remain unproven; the coach workspace is a phase-two product because it adds tenancy, permissions and sensitive-data complexity.

Current official benchmarks span Hevy Pro at USD 23.99/year, Oura at €69.99/year, and WHOOP One at USD 199/year including hardware.[1] [2] [3] Coach platforms validate capacity pricing: Hevy Coach lists USD 25/month for 1–10 clients, while Trainerize starts at USD 23/month for five.[4] [5]

2 Model universe and selection method

The review tested direct subscriptions, freemium, hard paywalls, per-decision charging, paid pilots, coach SaaS, gym licensing, enterprise wellness, API/data licensing, white-label/OEM, marketplaces, affiliate revenue and advertising.

Hard paywall is rejected for launch because value requires context over several sessions. Per-decision charging punishes habitual use at the moment of need. A marketplace requires two-sided liquidity and adds accountability complexity. Advertising and identifiable-data sales conflict with the consent-first proposition.

The ranking weights **problem fit 25%**; time to revenue, predictability, acquisition efficiency, scalability and execution feasibility **15% each**. Scores are strategic judgements, not market measurements.

Rank	Model	Score	Predictability	Acquisition
1	Layered freemium athlete subscription	7.95	Medium-high	High difficulty
2	Coach-sponsored B2B SaaS	7.25	High	Medium-high

Rank	Model	Score	Predictability	Acquisition
3	Gym/club cohort licence	6.70	High	Medium–high
4	Paid validation pilots	6.25	Low	Medium
5	Embedded decision API	6.10	High once contracted	Very high

3 Five most viable models

1	Layered freemium athlete subscription		7.95 / 10
How it works	Free users keep a thin ledger, ghost sets, limited history and one monthly decision preview. A 21-day reverse trial exposes Athlete capabilities; paid tiers unlock unlimited decisions, evidence cards, outcome memory, added sources and premium exports.		
Strengths	Direct match to the repeated pre-session job; self-serve global scale; recurring revenue; free utility reduces migration and trust friction.		
Weaknesses	Consumer CAC and churn can overwhelm revenue; free conversion may be low; the “aha” moment needs multiple sessions.		
Scalability	High —software and policy workflow scale without a human in each decision.		
Revenue predictability	Medium–high after paid renewal and cohort retention are proven.		
Acquisition difficulty	High without coach, club and community channels.		

2	Coach-sponsored B2B SaaS		7.25 / 10
How it works	A coach pays for capacity and invites athletes free. Consent-scoped evidence, low-confidence review queue, approve/amend/reject, decision history and audit export support the existing coaching service.		
Strengths	Clear economic buyer; one sale activates a cohort; accountability and retention are stronger; a coach can justify cost through time saved and client differentiation.		
Weaknesses	Requires multi-tenant authorisation, support and clear responsibility boundaries; incumbents already own coach workflows.		
Scalability	High after a repeatable workspace and onboarding model exist.		
Revenue predictability	High through monthly/annual capacity contracts.		
Acquisition difficulty	Medium–high ; targeted founder-led selling, but a longer trust cycle.		

3

Gym or club cohort licence

6.70 / 10

How it works	A CrossFit box, powerlifting club or premium gym buys annual access for a capped cohort, onboarding support and aggregate consent-safe usage reporting. Individual data remains private unless shared.
Strengths	Concentrated distribution, community habit formation, pilot credibility and annual contract value.
Weaknesses	Budgets vary; procurement is slower; gyms may not own members' programming; usage can be seasonal.
Scalability	Medium–high once onboarding and cohort administration are templated.
Revenue predictability	High with annual contracts, subject to renewal risk.
Acquisition difficulty	Medium–high through founder-led local sales and partnerships.

4

Paid validation pilots

6.25 / 10

How it works	A coach, gym, university lab or wearable partner pays a fixed fee for a 10–12 week co-design pilot, defined onboarding, a de-identified results report and credit toward a later subscription contract.
Strengths	Fastest credible early revenue; finances evidence generation; produces references, buyer discovery and implementation learning.
Weaknesses	Lumpy and service-heavy; governance effort erodes margin; can trap the company in bespoke consulting.
Scalability	Low–medium —valuable as a bridge, not the destination.
Revenue predictability	Low unless converted into repeatable contracts.
Acquisition difficulty	Medium ; consultative but accessible through Irish pilot partners.

5

Embedded decision API

6.10 / 10

How it works	Workout, wearable or coaching platforms submit a consented structured snapshot and receive an allowlisted proposal, evidence references, confidence, policy version and audit identifier. Price = platform fee + usage.
Strengths	Excellent technical scale; partner owns distribution; the schema, policy and outcome feedback loop can become infrastructure.
Weaknesses	Long partner sales; integration, indemnity and validation requirements; weak bargaining power before quality and outcome data exist.

Scalability	Very high technically.
Revenue predictability	High once contracted through minimum commitments and usage.
Acquisition difficulty	Very high ; enterprise product and due-diligence burden.

4 Top-model pricing architecture

Tier	Monthly	Annual	Included value
Free	€0	€0	One active block; manual logging; ghost sets; 30-day history; one decision preview/month; source labels; export/delete and core consent.
Athlete	€8.99	€79	Unlimited evidence-backed decisions; full training/decision history; manual/CSV or one recovery source; confidence/gaps/counterfactual; prepared session; outcome memory; standard exports.
Athlete Plus	€12.99	€119	Multiple recovery/nutrition sources as available; deeper block comparisons; advanced exports; early connectors; richer evidence summaries; priority support.
Coach Pilot	€29	€290	Up to 10 active athletes; linked Athlete access; consent-scoped review queue; approve/amend/reject; coach rationale; audit export; onboarding templates.

4.1 Why each price is defensible

Free proves that users will enter enough context and protects trust; it does not give away the recurring decision loop. **Athlete** equals €6.58/month annually—a 26.8% discount—positioning above commodity logbooks and close to Oura’s software membership. **Athlete Plus** equals €9.92/month annually—a 23.7% discount and roughly 51% price step-up—funded by integration breadth and analysis, never medical claims. **Coach Pilot** equals €24.17/month annually and is adjacent to official coach-platform entry prices.[2] [4] [5]

Trial design: after the first context-ready snapshot, give 21 days of Athlete without requiring a card. At expiry, preserve the ledger and records in Free. RevenueCat’s 2026 dataset reports materially better conversion for 17+ day trials than short trials; the product needs several sessions to show value.[6]

4.2 Price test, not price dogma

The €79 launch price reduces unproven-value risk. Run a controlled €79 vs €99 annual test after the beta, segmented by activation quality. Do not optimise for trial starts alone; require a context-ready snapshot, at least two reviewed proposals and a recorded outcome before judging conversion.

5 Unit economics and revenue landmarks

The pitch deck assumes €0.02 per decision. At 20 decisions/month, inference is €4.80 per athlete-year. Against €79 annual revenue, €74.20 remains before payments, hosting, storage, support, compliance, refunds and tax; this is **not** a full gross-margin calculation.

Paid Athlete users	ARR at €79	Interpretation
100	€7,900	First paid-demand gate; enough for qualitative cohort analysis, not a scalable business.
1,000	€79,000	Early recurring base; still requires founder-led acquisition discipline.
2,955	€233,445	The validation report's 1%-of-SAM scenario at the lower launch price; directional, not a forecast.

6 Monetisation roadmap and gates

Window	Commercial move	Gate before expansion
0–3 months	Free design-partner cohort	Activation, first snapshot, decision viewed, recorded outcome, week-4 retention and consent completion measured.
3–6 months	Reverse trial + €79/€99 test	At least 100 paid athletes; credible week-8 retained cohorts; contribution margin understood before paid acquisition.
6–12 months	Coach Pilot to 5–10 coaches	Live athlete cohort, recurring review job and willingness to pay; no empty review queue.
12–18 months	Gym cohort package	Repeatable onboarding, annual renewal signal and consent-safe reporting.
12–24 months	API design partnerships	Auditable decision quality, documented schemas, outcome data and partner due-diligence readiness.

7 Risks and commercial controls

Risk	Failure mode	Control / kill signal
Retention	Users like the demo but do not return before sessions.	Stop broad acquisition if active users fail to log two sessions/week or week-4 retention is weak.

Risk	Failure mode	Control / kill signal
Free cannibalisation	Ghost sets solve enough of the job.	Gate full decision history, recurring proposals and multi-source context; test upgrade triggers after demonstrated value.
Authority risk	Recommendation sounds clinical or certain.	Allowlisted actions, visible gaps/confidence, human approval, prohibited-claim tests and audit trail.
Coach mismatch	Coach sees the product as competition or extra work.	Position as a review/triage layer; pilot only with live cohorts and measure time saved.
Integration drag	Private APIs delay value and raise support cost.	Manual/CSV path first; connectors only after retention and source-demand evidence.
API premature scale	Partners demand validation and indemnity the startup cannot support.	No public API commercial launch until quality, security and partner obligations are demonstrably met.

8 References

- [1] Apple App Store, “Hevy — Workout Tracker Gym Log,” in-app purchase prices.
- [2] Oura, “Oura Membership,” EU price €5.99/month or €69.99/year, updated 1 September 2026.
- [3] WHOOP, membership pricing, One USD 199/year, Peak USD 239/year, Life USD 359/year.
- [4] Hevy Coach, USD 25/month for 1–10 clients.
- [5] ABC Trainerize, coach and studio pricing.
- [6] RevenueCat, State of Subscription Apps 2026, 115,000+ apps and USD 16bn revenue dataset.

Internal basis: all supplied Training Ledger documents and the latest Core Products, Development Plan and Sprint Plan were reviewed. Market sizes and price points are hypotheses until paid cohort evidence exists.